



MONTHLY UPDATE

Mauritius: monthly update, August – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-06 · 36 systems and instruments tracked

Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH · GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

Summary of the month

Government services moved online one at a time while the artificial-intelligence apparatus acquired a building. An online motor vehicle licence and road tax system launched at Port Louis on 18 August, an airport parking management system entered full operation, and Cabinet took note of a plan to consolidate government services onto a single personalised platform. The first artificial-intelligence innovation lab was inaugurated on 21 August under the national strategy and its FAIR guidelines.

Speech and security were the month's other subjects. The ministry reminded the public of the sanctions for undesirable online content and warned that online speech would be prosecuted, while a further communiqué set cybercrime reports for January to July against the number of investigators available. A two-year contract was signed to bring satellite connectivity to St Brandon.

Governance

Legislation and regulation

The omnibus introduced on 24 July 2026 runs to 119 pages, amends 58 Acts and repeals one, commencing in stages from 1 September 2026. A secondary account put the figure at some sixty laws; the enacting text gives the exact count.

The same bill redraws the virtual-asset perimeter around marketing rather than activity: unlicensed solicitation would be prohibited by any medium, reaching targeted advertising, platforms, social media, influencers, affiliates and referral codes, with any publicly accessible communication presumed to target Mauritius – which puts the burden on an offshore promoter to show it was not soliciting locally.

And on 30 July the ICT minister committed to Electronic Transactions Act amendments, with no text or date stated.

The primary text of the Data Protection Officer Regulations 2026 is now held, as Government Notice No. 117 of 2026 made under the Data Protection Act.

A third bill was set out in public rather than in print. The ICT minister said the Road Traffic (Amendment) Bill would make the digital driving licence an official electronic version equivalent to the traditional one and let holders settle fixed traffic penalties at any court and, above all, online, putting the affected population at more than 800,000 licence holders and saying the licence depends on interconnecting transport services, law enforcement and public administration. The Bill text is not held and no enactment or commencement date is stated.

Regional collaboration

The continental internet registry seated here is still without a settled board. One outlet's analysis records that the registry [named a person to all eight board seats on 12 September 2025 while withholding every candidate vote tally its own election guidelines promised](#), and that the appeal court has now [set aside its 2023 appeal for want of corporate authority without ruling on the official receiver's permission or on statutory leave](#). The chain from election through appointment to quorum is therefore unresolved and the receiver undischarged. No registry statement on the withheld tallies is held.

Standards

Mauritius moved to bind its own digital services to a standard. Cabinet [took note on 28 August of a Digital Service Framework setting mandatory principles and standards for every government digital service, from procurement through maintenance](#), and the government information service [set out that the framework will cover every service developed, procured or maintained by the state](#). Noted is not issued: the record held carries no compliance date, no owner and no consequence for a service that fails it.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

The month's sharpest domestic contribution was an argument about priority. A [named analyst published on 2 August](#) the case that contract enforcement rather than technology limits growth, citing the World Bank's 2025 indicators — 42.2 on ease of commercial dispute resolution against Singapore's 73.3 — and more than 70,000 cases pending at end-2025. Its digital prescription is digitalised case management alongside a small-claims process. Analysis, not evidence.

The month's other forum was external in origin. At the national Internet Governance Forum, founded by the Halley Movement, the [Blockchain for Good Alliance and the exchange Bybit met the Vice President and the ICT minister](#) to discuss artificial intelligence, cybersecurity and digital-trust frameworks for small island developing states. The record held is the visiting alliance's own press release; no forum programme, outcome document or attendance figure is held.

Finance

New investments

A United Nations development agency published its [country annual report for 2025](#), held in full. It is the agency's own account of its year rather than an independent evaluation, and the digital component is not separately costed in it, so no figure can be lifted from it for this section. What it gives the base is the shape of one external programme against which domestic appropriations can be read.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

The Prime Minister announced on [16 July 2026 that Mauritius will join the America-India Connect subsea cable programme](#). Reporting on [2 August established what sits behind it](#): a signed non-disclosure agreement, terms still under negotiation, no published timetable. The driver is ageing infrastructure — LION and LION2 still carry most international traffic — and the same account notes that Google already operates a ground station at Baie-du-Jacotet serviced by the state operator, so the cable would deepen a relationship rather than open one.

An industry survey put the 5G record on file for the first time: service since July 2021, when the state incumbent opened what the survey calls Africa's first 5G experience zones on spectrum assigned directly to the three operators, [reaching 86 per cent of the population in 2025](#) with take-up projected to move from 9 to 44 per cent. It is delivered mainly as home internet boxes and in shopping centres, business districts and the university.

Connectivity reached the remotest of the Outer Islands by contract if not yet by service. The ICT authority [awarded a two-year contract on 28 August to provide satellite-based internet and communications to Raphael Island in the St Brandon archipelago, a first for the archipelago, with the coast guard, the meteorological services and the island's fishing company as partners](#); no service date, capacity or value is stated.

Data Storage

At the regional summit on 17 August the prime minister announced [a carrier-neutral green data centre and a "Digital Embassy Village"](#) as the digital leg of a bid to position the country as a regional hub and gateway. No site, capacity, cost, operator or date is stated, which is what separates it from the two data centres already running.

Energy

Cabinet also [approved for signature a memorandum with Saudi Arabia](#) putting digital transformation and energy-sector cybersecurity alongside hydrocarbons — an approval to sign, not a signature, with no date, term, value or committed system stated.

Cybersecurity

Two cyber measures moved. The [July omnibus would empower the central bank to establish a cyber threat intelligence sharing platform](#) and to require financial institutions, and others it specifies, to participate — the clearest instance of mandatory threat-intelligence sharing in primary legislation on this record. At a [workshop on 29 July](#) the postal operator began being wired into the Universal Postal Union's global postal threat-sharing centre, with the ICT minister naming ISO/IEC 27001 as the standard he wants adopted.

August supplied the first figure for what any of this is against: [more than 4,000 reported cyber incidents in Mauritius since January 2026](#), given at the launch of the schools awareness programme. No reporting body, definition or comparable earlier period is named with it.

The ministry's own communique put [4,076 cybersecurity and online-behaviour reports between January and July 2026 against a cybercrime unit of seventeen investigators](#). Both figures come from the same communique, which is what makes the ratio quotable.

The instrument behind the blocking figures is now held, and it settles how they are counted. [Telecommunication Directive 2 of 2025, issued on 24 March 2025 under the ICT Act, moved the four internet service licence holders off the regulator's centralised child-sexual-abuse filter and onto on-premises filtering in each operator's own network against the Project Arachnid blacklist by 1 May 2025, with no deep packet inspection, HTTPS blocking only at domain level, monthly returns of access attempts and blocked addresses and domains, and an annual external security audit](#). The blocked-attempt totals the base carries are therefore hit counts against a list, not unique users and not confirmed retrievals.

DPI

Digital Payments and Fintech

The financial services regulator [issued guidance notes on stablecoins, with an annexure, on 13 August](#), the latest instalment of its fintech series. It follows the central bank's guideline for payment aggregators in July, which brought aggregators under a stated supervisory expectation for the first time. Two regulators have now written to two edges of the payments market inside six weeks; neither instrument carries an enforcement power the base can see used, and no complaint volume or redress route for payment users is published anywhere.

Registries

The [Finance Act 2026 was assented on 12 August](#), carrying the statutory changes behind the budget's identity, registry and statistics measures. It lands on a civil status register whose [system replacement was announced in September 2025](#) and has not yet been reported delivered. The register runs under a 1981 statute; the Act amends around it rather than replacing it, which is the pattern across this ledger's registries.

Sectoral management information systems

Two sector information systems sit at opposite ends of the same problem this window. A validation workshop [endorsed a proposal for a national Fisheries Information System, for submission under a multilateral fisheries fund's project-implementation grant window](#) — a system that does not exist yet and has no award behind it. Meanwhile the health estate shows what happens after a system is built: patients discharged from a national centre [were reported still looking for their medical records](#), against a one-patient-one-record ambition. The base holds no delivery figure for either.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

The same omnibus also gives clinical trials a statutory electronic licensing system, with the procedure written into the same Act as the channel.

A smaller service went live rather than being provided for. On 18 August the transport and IT ministries [launched an online motor vehicle licence system letting taxi operators renew the licence and pay road tax without visiting a post office or a land transport counter](#), which the ministry says will also build a database of operators, alongside a website for the operators' welfare fund — 6,567 registered members of 7,802 operators, with about 3,000 already on an electronic platform. The authority's underlying system is stated as outdated and a tender has been launched to upgrade it; no transaction volume, cost or extension beyond taxi operators is published.

A smaller service is being taken online with its own figures attached: commercial-weighting oversight, which [verified 12,412 measuring instruments across 4,971 businesses and inspected 4,974 shops in 2025-2026, is moving bookings, payments and certificates onto a new platform](#). No go-live date or cost is stated.

Cabinet [took note of a plan to consolidate the government portal and the separate official websites into a single citizen-centred platform](#). Taking note is not approval, and no budget, supplier or delivery date accompanies it.

Digitalisation

Rural digital data capture

The [virtual reality programme in primary schools](#) is the second digital programme now running in the primary estate, after the [education platform launched in January](#) under the operator pilot. Neither publishes a school count or a pupil reach. On an island of this size the rural indicators are answered by national programmes rather than by a rural one, and what the base cannot say of either programme is how much of the estate it has reached.

Technology

AI

The state's artificial-intelligence apparatus gained a building and the incumbent operator gained a language. The [first AI Innovation Lab was inaugurated on 21 August under the national strategy and its FAIR guidelines](#); no capacity, staffing, access rule or research programme is published for it.

The incumbent operator set out what sits behind its own platform. Its chief executive described [a cloud partnership with a hyperscaler, sovereign data centres, a plan to train 50,000 people in artificial-intelligence skills, and a voice model built for Mauritian Creole](#), and recorded a retreat in the same interview: the schools pilot moved from a student tutor to a teacher assistant after teacher and parent resistance. The figures and the claim of a first are the operator's own, given in an interview.

Capacity

Training and skills

The incumbent operator opened a national cybersecurity and artificial-intelligence awareness programme for secondary students with the education ministry, [starting on 13 August at the Mahatma Gandhi Institute with about 500 Grade 10 to Grade 12 students drawn from all four education zones](#), and free ten-hour AWS training on offer alongside. A [companion account of the same workshop](#) describes its content as online risk and responsible use of new technologies. It is an operator-run programme rather than a curriculum change, and no full-year target, budget or evaluation is stated.

Data

National statistics

The central bank opened its own statistics rather than waiting for the statutory framework to be rewritten. It [launched a central statistical database on 3 September, developed with the International Monetary Fund and the African Development Bank, opening statistical information to businesses, researchers, policymakers and citizens](#); the prime minister said a standards and codes report had underscored the need to strengthen statistical capacity and modernise dissemination, and that the statistics statute and the central bank statute are being reviewed. No series list, update cadence, licence or machine-readable access route is stated for the portal.

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

The summit's other announcements differ in kind. The [Amazon memorandum was executed at the opening ceremony](#) with soft scope and no disclosed value, and [its training will run initially in rented premises](#). The claim that the operator's data centre already hosts current-generation accelerators is the chief executive's own.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	2026-09-06
CURRENT EDITION	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/MUS/MUS-monthly.html
THIS FILE	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/MUS/MUS-monthly-2026-09-06.pdf
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